SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #78 · DEATH & GRIEF

# “Being afraid of death means my faith is weak.”

✦ ✦ ✦

## Where it often comes from

Hearing that Christians should welcome death without fear. Anxiety about dying, illness, or the unknown. Comparing yourself with people who seem peaceful about death. Painful experiences of watching someone die. Health scares that bring fear to the surface.

## What Scripture teaches

Death is an enemy, and it is natural to feel fear about it. Even Jesus was deeply troubled before His death. Scripture says Christ shared our humanity to free those who all their lives were held in slavery by the fear of death. Fear of death is something He came to heal, not something He condemns. He has prepared a place for you, and through Him death has lost its sting.

> *“Now since the children have flesh and blood, He too shared in their humanity, so that by His death He might destroy him who holds the power of death, that is, the devil, and free those who all their lives were held in slavery by their fear of death”* **(Hebrews 2:14–15)**.

## Also see

> “‘Do not let your hearts be troubled. You believe in God; believe in Me as well. In My Father’s house are many rooms. If it were not so, would I have told you that I am going there to prepare a place for you? And if I go and prepare a place for you, I will come back and welcome you into My presence, so that you also may be where I am.’” **(John 14:1–3)**.

> “‘Where, O Death, is your victory? Where, O Death, is your sting?’ The sting of death is sin, and the power of sin is the law. But thanks be to God, who gives us the victory through our Lord Jesus Christ!” **(1 Corinthians 15:55–57)**.

> “Even though I walk through the valley of the shadow of death, I will fear no evil, for You are with me; Your rod and Your staff, they comfort me” **(Psalm 23:4)**.

> “Jesus said to her, ‘I am the resurrection and the life. Whoever believes in Me will live, even though he dies. And everyone who lives and believes in Me will never die. Do you believe this?’” **(John 11:25–26)**.

## Common self-statements

- If I had real faith, I wouldn’t be afraid to die.
- My fear proves I’m not sure of heaven.
- Good Christians are excited to die.
- I’m ashamed of being afraid.
- I can’t admit this fear to anyone.
- My fear must mean I’m not saved.

## Common logical errors

- **All-or-nothing thinking:** Believing you must either have no fear or weak faith.
- **Should statements:** “I should never be afraid of death.”
- **Emotional reasoning:** Concluding “I feel afraid, so my faith must be weak.”

- **Comparison:** Comparing your feelings to others' apparent calm.

## Challenging questions

- Why did Christ share our humanity, according to Hebrews 2:15?
- Was Jesus troubled before His death?
- Does Scripture call death a friend or an enemy?
- What has Jesus prepared for me?
- What does 1 Corinthians 15 say has happened to death's sting?
- Is my fear about death itself, about pain, or about leaving people?
- Can I bring this fear to Jesus and let Him comfort me?

## Truth summary

> Being afraid of death does not mean my faith is weak. Death is an enemy, and Jesus came to free people from the fear of it. He has prepared a place for me and has taken away death's sting. I can bring my fear to Him, and He will comfort me as I walk through the valley.

## Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Death/Dying
- Fear
- Eternal Life
- Heaven
- Peace

**Godly Counsel Lessons:**

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Death and Dying
- Anxiety/Worry/Fear

## Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> **Overcoming Anxiety** · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

*Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"*

✦ ✦ ✦

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

# My Plan for Replacing "Being afraid of death means my faith is weak"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

**Name:** _____ **Date started:** _____

## 1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

*Rate it now so you can see your progress later.*

**"Being afraid of death means my faith is weak."** I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

## 2 My best question

*The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.*

- ☐ Why did Christ share our humanity?
- ☐ Was Jesus troubled before His death?
- ☐ Is death a friend or an enemy?
- ☐ What has Jesus prepared for me?
- ☐ What happened to death's sting?
- ☐ What exactly am I afraid of?

**My own question:** _____

## 3 My replacement truth

*The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.*

- ☐ Fear of death does not mean weak faith.
- ☐ Jesus came to free me from the fear of death.
- ☐ Jesus has prepared a place for me.
- ☐ Death has lost its sting.
- ☐ God is with me in the valley.
- ☐ Jesus is the resurrection and the life.

**In my own words:** _____

## 4 My Scripture

*The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.*

- [ ] **Hebrews 2:14–15**
  *"Now since the children have flesh and blood, He too shared in their humanity, so that by His death He might destroy him who holds the power of death, that is, the devil, and free those who all their lives were held in slavery by their fear of death."*

- [ ] **John 14:1–3**
  *"'Do not let your hearts be troubled. You believe in God; believe in Me as well. In My Father's house are many rooms. If it were not so, would I have told you that I am going there to prepare a place for you? And if I go and prepare a place for you, I will come back and welcome you into My presence, so that you also may be where I am.'"*

- [ ] **1 Corinthians 15:55–57**
  *"'Where, O Death, is your victory? Where, O Death, is your sting?' The sting of death is sin, and the power of sin is the law. But thanks be to God, who gives us the victory through our Lord Jesus Christ!"*

- [ ] **Psalm 23:4**
  *"Even though I walk through the valley of the shadow of death, I will fear no evil, for You are with me; Your rod and Your staff, they comfort me."*

- [ ] **John 11:25–26**
  *"Jesus said to her, 'I am the resurrection and the life. Whoever believes in Me will live, even though he dies. And everyone who lives and believes in Me will never die. Do you believe this?'"*

**A verse I found myself:** _____

✦ ✦ ✦

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

# Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

## 5 My practice plan

*Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.*

### EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

### PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Fear and hope log:** When fear of death comes, write it down and answer it with one promise from Jesus.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, Psalm 23:4 becomes: "Even though **Sarah** walks through the valley of the shadow of death, **she** will fear no evil, for You are with **her**; Your rod and Your staff, they comfort **her**."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Death/Dying" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

## 6 My action step this week

*Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.*

- ☐ **Write down exactly what you fear about death,** and next to each fear write a promise of God.
- ☐ **Read John 14:1–6 each night this week** before sleep.
- ☐ **Talk honestly with a pastor or mature believer** about your fear.
- ☐ **If health anxiety is strong,** talk with your doctor or a Christian counselor.

**What I will do:** _____

**When:** _____

**What the lie predicts will happen:** _____

## 7 End-of-week check-in

*Bring this page to your next session.*

**What actually happened:** _____

**What I learned:** _____

**The lie** "Being afraid of death means my faith is weak": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

## Daily practice tracker

| Day | Read my card | Said my verse | Used my reminder | One fear I answered with a promise |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Mon | | | | |
| Tue | | | | |
| Wed | | | | |
| Thu | | | | |
| Fri | | | | |
| Sat | | | | |
| Sun | | | | |

## My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Being afraid of death means my faith is weak.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

*Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.*

## Prayer

*Lord Jesus, thank You that You came to free me from the fear of death. Help me reject the lie that being afraid means my faith is weak. When I am afraid, comfort me with Your presence and Your promises. Thank You for the place You are preparing for me. In Your name, Amen.*

✦ ✦ ✦

*Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.*